

YU ZHOU

✉ yuzhou@cs.ucla.edu  [Google Scholar](#)  [Homepage](#)

RESEARCH AREA

Foundation models for grounded visual reasoning; RL for visual and embodied agents; multimodal tool-use agents.

EDUCATION

University of California, Los Angeles

2024 - Present

Ph.D. Computer Science

Advisors: Kai-Wei Chang, Nanyun Peng

University of California, Los Angeles

2019 - 2023

B.S. Mathematics, minor in Data Engineering

EXPERIENCE

Meta Superintelligence Labs

Jun 2025 - Sep 2025

Research Scientist Intern

- *Mentor: Pengchuan Zhang*
- Lead agentic tool-use efforts with SAM3 Agent for grounding any complex reasoning-based textual query.
- SAM 3: Segment Anything with Concepts .

Stanford University

Mar 2024 - Sep 2024

Visiting Researcher at SVL

- *Mentors: Jiajun Wu, Fei-Fei Li*
- Holistically evaluate MLLMs for dynamic world modeling and embodied decision making.
- Build large-scale virtual simulation datasets and decision making interface for embodied agents.

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign

May 2022 - Jan 2023

Research Intern

- *Mentors: Manling Li, Heng Ji, Mohit Bansal*
- Training models to perform non-sequential procedural planning from large-scale video and text data.

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

SAM 3: Segment Anything with Concepts 

ICLR 2026

Meta Segment Anything 3 Team: Yu Zhou

ENACT: Evaluating Embodied Cognition with World Modeling of Egocentric Interaction 

ICLR 2026

Outstanding Paper Awards at ICLR 2026 World Models Workshop and Lifelong Agents Workshop

Qineng Wang, Wenlong Huang*, Yu Zhou, Hang Yin, Tianwei Bao, Jianwen Lyu, Weiyu Liu, Ruohan Zhang, Jiajun Wu, Li Fei-Fei, Manling Li*

Contrastive Visual Data Augmentation 

ICML 2025

Yu Zhou, Bingxuan Li*, Mohan Tang*, Xiaomeng Jin, Te-Lin Wu, Kuan-Hao Huang, Heng Ji, Kai-Wei Chang, Nanyun Peng*

Embodied Agent Interface: Benchmarking LLMs for Embodied Decision Making 

NeurIPS 2024 (*Oral*)

Best Paper Award at SoCal NLP Symposium 2024 (1 / 166 accepted papers)

Manling Li, Shiyu Zhao*, Qineng Wang*, Kangrui Wang*, Yu Zhou* (equal contribution), Sanjana Srivastava, Cem Gokmen, Tony Lee, Li Erran Li, Ruohan Zhang, Weiyu Liu, Percy Liang, Li Fei-Fei, Jiayuan Mao, Jiajun Wu*

Localizing Active Objects from Egocentric Vision with Symbolic World Knowledge 

EMNLP 2023 (*Oral*)

Te-Lin Wu, Yu Zhou* (equal contribution), Nanyun Peng*

DISTINCTIONS

Apr 2026 Outstanding paper award at ICLR 2026 World Models Workshop

Apr 2026 Outstanding paper award at ICLR 2026 Lifelong Agents Workshop

Dec 2025 Spotlight presentation at NeurIPS 2025 Language, Agent, and World Models Workshop

Dec 2024 Research highlighted at NeurIPS 2024 opening keynote

Dec 2024 Oral presentation at NeurIPS 2024 (Top 0.4%)

Nov 2024 Best paper award at SoCal NLP Symposium 2024 (1 / 166 Accepted Papers)

Sept 2024 UCLA Graduate Student Fellowship

May 2024 Cohere AI Research Grant

SERVICES

Workshop Organizer: Foundation Models Meet Embodied Agents @ CVPR 2025 [↗](#)

Challenge Organizer: Embodied Agent Interface Challenge @ NeurIPS 2025 [↗](#)

Reviewer: JMLR, NeurIPS, ICLR, ICML, CVPR, ECCV, COLM, ACL, EMNLP

TALKS

Jan 2026 Nuclear Physics Group, UCLA [↗](#)

Nov 2025 Information Sciences Institute (ISI), USC [↗](#)

Aug 2025 Salesforce AI Research Future Forum [↗](#)